

2418–2430 N. Milwaukee Ave

Logan Square · Chicago, IL 60647 · 4-Parcel Assemblage · 28,905 SF · Built 1908

OUR TAKE

This property has real potential — and real baggage.

The location and zoning are genuinely strong. But the current owner is in active foreclosure and the building carries legal, physical, and tax constraints that a listing won't mention. Go in with eyes open.

LAST SOLD \$4.78M April 2025	PRIOR SALE \$5.83M August 2018 — seller took a loss	ZONING C1-3 Neighborhood Commercial	PROPERTY TAXES \$125K/yr 2024 — fully paid	TITLE STATUS ■ Flagged Active foreclosure filed Dec 2025	LANDMARK Orange Tag Exterior changes need city review
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WHAT THE PUBLIC RECORD SAYS ABOUT THIS ASSET

Independent of what you plan to do with it

■ The owner is in foreclosure — 8 months after buying it.

J2 Hollander LLC paid \$4.78M in April 2025. By December 2025, a foreclosure action (Lis Pendens) was filed against them — on both the primary parcel and the co-parcel. A personal mechanics lien appeared in May 2025, weeks after closing, suggesting a contractor dispute erupted almost immediately. This is not a slow-moving problem. This is a seller in active financial distress. That changes how you negotiate — but it also means title is clouded right now. No lender will finance this property until the foreclosure is resolved.

■ Two owners. Seven years. Both lost money.

The prior owner (GW Logan Square LLC) paid \$5.83M in 2018 and sold for \$4.78M in 2025 — a loss of over \$1 million in one of Chicago's strongest neighborhoods, after 7 years. Before you assume that's bad luck, know that they fought the city assessor in court every single year trying to reduce their tax bill, and the project they planned was blocked for years by political friction at City Hall. The current owner hit financial distress in under a year. This property has actively resisted development. You need to understand why before you commit.

\$ The tax bill is \$125,000 a year — and it's probably going up.

Property taxes were \$125,085 in 2024, fully paid. That sounds manageable until you realize it works out to \$10,400 every single month before you pay a mortgage, cover operating costs, or earn a dollar of income. The city assessor currently values this property at \$9.24M — a number the prior owner contested and got reduced in 2024. The new owner hasn't filed an appeal yet. If you buy this, filing a tax appeal on day one is not optional.

■ It's a landmark. You can't change the outside without city approval.

The Hollander Building carries an Orange Tag from the Chicago Historic Resources Survey — meaning it's considered locally significant. Any exterior modification requires review by the Commission on Chicago Landmarks: windows, doors, facade materials, storefront design, signage. This isn't a dealbreaker, but it adds time and cost to any renovation, and some changes may simply be denied. Get a pre-consultation with the Landmarks Division before you finalize any plans.

✓ Retail on the ground floor, housing above — no special permits needed.

The property is zoned C1-3 (Neighborhood Commercial). Under this zoning, a ground-floor retail or restaurant space with residential units above is permitted as-of-right — meaning no special hearings, no Zoning Board of Appeals, no alderman approval required. This is your cleanest path. The prior owner's years of political battles were tied to a specific design proposal, not the zoning category itself. A standard mixed-use program avoids that friction entirely.

■ The City Council approval for apartments has likely expired.

City Council approved a residential conversion plan in July 2024. In Chicago, a building permit must be pulled within 12 months of a zoning approval — or the entitlement lapses and you start over. No permit was pulled. This is actually two things at once: the entitlement the prior owner spent years fighting for is probably gone, but for a straightforward mixed-use program you may not need it at all. Confirm with a zoning attorney before assuming you're inheriting a ready-to-build approval — or that you need one.

↑ The neighborhood demand is genuinely strong — this isn't hype.

Logan Square consistently ranks in the top tier of Chicago neighborhoods for real estate activity. Two Blue Line stops are within half a mile, both seeing ridership growth above 20% over three years. Rents for 2-bedroom and larger units run 12–75% above the federal Fair Market Rent baseline. There are 11 Michelin-recognized restaurants within 1 mile — a reliable indicator of foot traffic and disposable income in the area. If you can solve the asset's problems, the market will show up.

■ The building is maxed out. You can't add square footage.

At 28,905 SF on a combined lot of 18,620 SF, this building already exceeds its zoning's maximum Floor Area Ratio by 29%. That makes it legally non-conforming — grandfathered, but frozen. You cannot build an addition, add a floor, or expand the footprint without a variance. What exists is what you have to work with. For a conversion play this is fine — but if your plan depends on adding square footage, this property won't support it.

BEFORE YOU MOVE FORWARD

Three things to do before you make an offer

1**Get a title search done first.**

There are 64 recorded documents on this PIN, an active foreclosure, and a personal mechanics lien on the owner. A title search will tell you exactly what you'd be buying into — and whether it's even possible to close right now.

2**Call a zoning attorney before you call an architect.**

Confirm whether the 2024 City Council approval has lapsed, and whether your intended use qualifies as-of-right under C1-3. These two answers will determine your timeline and your risk. Thomas Moore has handled 10 Ward 1 zoning cases in the past 5 years with a 9/10 approval record.

3**Don't use the county's income estimate to underwrite this deal.**

The report shows an NOI of \$258,596 — that number comes from a county formula based on the self-storage classification. It has nothing to do with actual income from a mixed-use building. Build your own numbers from real market rents and real operating costs before you decide what this property is worth to you.